Bhindranwale to tell Longowal not to surrender, but could not or did not want to return.

According to SGPC secretary Bhan Singh, one of the survivors of the operation who was present in the complex, there were 250 other persons in Teja Singh Samundri Hall who were asked to come out and sit in the courtyard of Guru Ramdas hostel. [15] Some extremists threw grenades on them to stop them from surrendering. In the morning, about seventy dead bodies were found in the compound, including those of children and women. Though the Central government white paper issued in July 1984 admitted that seventy people including thirty women and five children died in that incident, the blame for it was put entirely on the militants.

According to Bhan Singh, the survivors were made to sit in the courtyard of Guru Ram Das Sarai without food, drink or medical aid till the curfew was lifted the next evening. Bhan Singh also told Khushwant Singh that he saw about thirty-five Sikhs brought out from the Teja Singh Samundri Hall, made to line up with their hands raised above their heads and shot dead by the army.

The Kumaon regiment also entered Guru Ram Das Sarai at the same time and ordered everyone to come out. According to one eyewitness, as quoted by Mark Tully and Satish Jacob in *Amritsar: Mrs Gandhi's Last Battle,* early in the morning of 6 June, all the pilgrims were taken into the courtyard and the men were separated from the women. The men were asked to take off their turbans, using which their hands were tied behind their backs. In addition, about 150 persons were taken out of the basement and asked to hold their hands up and shot after fifteen minutes. [16]

The persons from the basement were Bangladeshi Muslims whom the Pakistan government had refused to accept. According to a letter written to President Zail Singh by an elder of a village, a few of whose residents were locked in room 61 of Guru Ramdas Sarai, about sixty pilgrims were locked up in that room during the hot and sultry night between 5 June and 6 June. The only door and all windows of this room were shut. When the door of the room was opened at 8 a.m. on 6 June, fifty-five of the sixty pilgrims had died.